

My Role in the Team

You don't have one role in a team — you have several, and they change. Players discover which roles they fill and which they want to develop.

 40 minutes

 Group + Individual

3 exercises

Evidence-based

What will you take with you today?

You can name your **current role(s)** in the team with concrete examples.

You understand why role clarity contributes to team cohesion and motivation.

You formulate **one concrete contribution** you want to strengthen in the coming months.

Bruner et al. (2021) — meta-analysis: role clarity is the strongest predictor of both task and social cohesion in sport teams (effect size $d=0.62$). *Journal of Sport Sciences*.

Eys et al. (2015) — season study with 248 basketball players: role ambiguity is negatively linked to confidence and positively to anxiety. *Sport, Exercise & Performance Psychology*.

Carron & Eys (2012) — Team cohesion model: athletes who actively invest in their role perform significantly better than those who merely accept their role.

Role Compass

Give yourself a score from 0 to 10 for each of the four roles

LEADER · ENGINE

Leader — gives direction, addresses the group. **Engine** — gives energy, pulls the team along.

THINKER · STEADY FORCE

Thinker — analyses, asks questions, seeks solutions. **Steady Force** — reliable, consistent, support for others.

SCORING

Players score themselves 0-10 on each role. Not a ranking — a Steady Force is as valuable as a Leader.

Note: scores are not a ranking. Cultures that only reward leaders create internal competition instead of collaboration.

2

My Top 3 Contributions

Write three things you contributed in terms of behaviour, attitude or character — not on the scoreboard.

Repeat this exercise every month. Players who see themselves grow in contribution perform better and drop out less.

Use roles in your language: 'Tom, you're our Engine today.' This strengthens identity and gives direction without hierarchy.

3

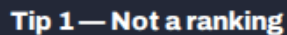
Role Circle

Stand in a circle. Each player says: 'My contribution to this team is...' Start yourself as coach to lower the threshold.

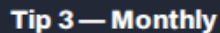
After each player, one teammate adds what they also see — positive only, no 'yes but'. Close: 'Everyone has a role. No one is unimportant.'

After the exercise: have players note which teammate's contribution surprised them — what did you never expect?

Phil Jackson — 11x NBA Championship coach



'Tom, you're our Engine today.' This strengthens identity and gives direction without hierarchy.



Players who consistently score low on all roles may feel unseen. Plan an individual conversation.

40-minute session

8' Fill in Role Compass individually

5' Reflection and worksheet
min

5' Closing with quote and intention

MONTH 3 OF 8 · MY ROLE IN THE TEAM

Everyone matters.

Today you saw that every role makes the team stronger — even the invisible ones.

⚡ TEAM RITUAL · I TAKE WITH ME...

 I take with me...

Each player says in maximum 5 words what they take from this session. Start yourself. Short and powerful — no explanation needed.

NEXT MONTH → COMMUNICATION

Ask players to have one conversation this week they've been putting off. Next month is all about communication.